



STRATA

Browse in context.

DOC 02 · PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

# Product Requirements Document

Vision, users, core features (Continuum, Moments, Rewind, Freeze), scope boundaries, and success metrics for Strata.

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strata — local-first browser  
confidential — internal working document

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## Executive Summary

**Strata** is a modern, privacy-first, Chromium-based desktop browser. Its defining feature, **Continuum**, builds a local timeline of browsing context and lets users save and restore **Moments** — complete workspaces of tabs, layout, and page position, not just a list of URLs.

```
Traditional browsers:  Tabs → URLs → History → Bookmarks
Strata:                Tabs → Context → Moments → Continuity
```

Strata does not just reopen a tab. **It reopens where you left off** — and it does this entirely on the user's machine, with no AI, no account, and no cloud dependency by default.

### For

People who run long, multi-tab research sessions and lose the thread when they close the browser or restart their machine.

### Strata is

A fast, minimal, keyboard-friendly desktop browser with one deep, genuinely new feature instead of ten shallow ones.

### Strata is not

An AI browser, a Chrome skin, or a bookmarking tool. See Non-Goals, §5.

## Problem Statement

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A focused browsing session rarely lives in one tab. A user researching, say, React authentication might spend 45 minutes across five documentation pages, three GitHub repositories, two Stack Overflow threads, one YouTube video, and several searches. Today's browsers record none of the *structure* of that session:

- History is a flat, chronological list of URLs — it answers "where did I go," never "what was I doing."
- Closing tabs (accidentally, to free memory, or at end of day) destroys the session's shape entirely — tab order, split arrangement, and scroll position are all gone.
- Bookmarks capture a single page, not a working set of pages plus the layout the user had them in.
- "Restore last session" restores raw tabs, not context — no framing, no name, no ability to keep three different research threads alive independently.

### INSIGHT

The unit of value in a browsing session isn't the individual page — it's the **working set** the user assembled. Strata makes that working set a first-class, savable, restorable object.

# Target Users

| PERSONA                                | BEHAVIOR                                                                                                  | WHAT STRATA GIVES THEM                                                         |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Developer / power researcher           | Runs parallel investigations across docs, GitHub, Stack Overflow; context-switches between projects daily | Freeze a research thread mid-task, resume it days later exactly where it stood |
| Student / self-learner                 | Follows tutorials and reference material across many tabs over a long session                             | Rewind to "where was I in this tutorial" instead of re-finding five tabs       |
| Privacy-conscious user                 | Wants a fast, modern browser without accounts, telemetry, or AI features watching their browsing          | Local-first by default; nothing leaves the machine unless explicitly enabled   |
| Knowledge worker with parallel threads | Job search, a home renovation, a side project — several long-running, unrelated browsing contexts at once | Named Moments per thread, kept alive independently, no tab-hoarding required   |

## Product Principles

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1

### Local-first

Browsing history and Moments stay on the user's machine by default. No account required to use the full product.

2

### No AI

No AI assistant, AI search, AI summaries, AI tab grouping, or AI recommendations — anywhere, ever, as currently scoped. This is a brand commitment, not a Phase-1 omission.

3

### Fast

The browser should feel instant: sub-2-second startup, 60fps+ chrome, immediate tab switching. See TRD §6 for hard targets.

4

### Minimal

Don't copy Chrome's feature-heavy interface. Every surface earns its place or is cut.

5

### Context over history

History tells you where you've been. Continuum tells you what you were doing.

6

### User control

Users can pause Continuum, delete Moments, clear history, disable state recording, and use private browsing at any time.

## Core Feature: Continuum

Continuum is Strata's local browsing-state system. Instead of a flat URL list, it records structured, meaningful state per tab:

```
Website
├─ URL, title, favicon, timestamp
├─ scroll position, zoom
├─ navigation state, tab relationship
├─ split-screen position
├─ selected text
├─ saved page state (best-effort – see §6)
└─ user-created annotations / Moments
```

### Moments

A **Moment** is a persistent, named snapshot of a browsing context: which tabs were open, their split layout, and each page's scroll/zoom position. A Moment survives closing every one of its tabs — the user can close everything and, weeks later, restore the full workspace from *Moments* → *[name]* → *Restore*.

### Rewind

A toolbar control (↶) opens **Continuum**, a visual timeline of recent browsing activity grouped by time, similar in spirit to history but structured as events (navigation, tab creation, split, moment saved) rather than a flat log. Selecting any event restores that browsing context as closely as possible.

### Freeze

Right-clicking any tab offers **Freeze Moment** — capture the current context and allow the tab to be closed immediately, without losing it. Frozen contexts appear alongside explicitly-saved Moments.

## Technical Reality & Honesty Contract

Not every website exposes enough information for Strata to restore every aspect of state. This is communicated to users directly rather than papered over.

### Reliably restored (browser-owned)

URL, title, tab identity, navigation history, scroll position, zoom, window/split arrangement, timestamps.

### Best-effort only (page-owned)

Arbitrary JS application state, authentication state, unsaved form data, canvas state — captured where technically possible, never guaranteed.

### PRODUCT COMMITMENT

Continuum guarantees restoration of browser-owned state and attempts best-effort restoration of page-owned state. Strata never promises perfect reconstruction of every website, in-product copy or marketing.



## Explicitly Out of Scope

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- **No AI features of any kind** — this is checked at every roadmap review, not just at launch.
- **No cloud sync by default** — Continuum data never leaves the machine unless a future, explicit, opt-in sync feature is enabled.
- **No feature-parity chase with Chrome** — extensions, sync, multi-profile power features, and themes are explicitly "Later" (see Implementation Plan), not MVP.
- **No perfect state reconstruction promise** — see §6.
- **No three-platform launch** — Windows ships first; macOS and Linux follow once Windows is solid.

## Success Metrics

| METRIC                                                       | WHY IT MATTERS                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cold start time (P50/P95)                                    | Directly tests the "Fast" principle; target < 2s on a modern machine                                      |
| % of sessions with ≥1 Moment saved or frozen                 | Adoption signal for the core differentiator                                                               |
| Restoration fidelity rate on browser-owned state             | Trust in the product's central promise; should approach 100% since this state is fully browser-controlled |
| Time-to-resume a Moment vs. manually reopening the same tabs | Quantifies the value Continuum actually delivers over "just remembering yourself"                         |
| Continuum recording overhead (CPU/UI jank)                   | Guards against the feature undermining the "Fast" principle it's meant to complement                      |

## Brand Language

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### Avoid

"AI-powered browsing." "The future of the web."  
"Supercharged productivity."

### Use

"Browse in context." "Don't just reopen a tab. Reopen where you left off." "The browser that remembers your place."

Every line of product copy is reviewed against the six product principles above before it ships — a marketing line that implies AI, cloud-first behavior, or feature-bloat is a bug, not a style choice.